

AXIOM AI TECHNOLOGIES

Business Continuity Plan

Business Continuity & Disaster Recovery

Document Control

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Portfolio Disclaimer: Axiom AI Technologies is a fictional organization created for cybersecurity/GRC portfolio purposes. This document is a modeled demonstration and does not represent an actual organization's certification, audit opinion, operational capability, or confidential information.

1. Purpose

The purpose of this Business Continuity Plan (BCP) is to establish the procedures and responsibilities required to maintain critical business activities during a disruptive event and to support the organization's transition back to normal operations.

The plan translates the requirements established in the **Business Impact Analysis (BIA)** and the **BCP/DR Strategy** into practical business continuity procedures.

The plan focuses on maintaining critical business functions while technical recovery activities are performed through the organization's Disaster Recovery Plan.

2. Objectives

The objectives of this plan are to:

- Protect personnel and critical information.
 - Maintain critical business operations during disruption.
 - Establish clear activation and escalation procedures.
 - Define business continuity roles and responsibilities.
 - Prioritize activities according to BIA recovery requirements.
 - Provide manual workarounds where primary systems are unavailable.
 - Maintain internal and external communications.
 - Coordinate with critical suppliers and service providers.
 - Support technical recovery activities.
 - Establish criteria for returning to normal operations.
 - Capture lessons learned and identify improvement opportunities.
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3. Scope

This plan applies to the business activities and supporting capabilities identified as critical or important within the Axiom AI Technologies BIA.

The plan addresses continuity of:

- Customer Support & Service Operations
- SaaS Platform Operations
- Identity & Access Administration
- Security Monitoring & Incident Response
- Software Development & Release Management
- Vulnerability Management & Security Remediation
- Third-Party & Supplier Security Management
- ISMS Governance & Compliance
- Customer & Business Communications
- Backup, Recovery & Data Restoration

The plan covers business continuity activities before, during, and immediately following a significant disruption.

Detailed technical restoration procedures are maintained separately within the Disaster Recovery Plan.

4. Relationship to Other Documents

The Business Continuity Plan forms part of the broader continuity and recovery framework.

The relationship between the documents is:

Business Impact Analysis

Identifies critical activities, impacts, dependencies, MTPD, RTO, and RPO.

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BCP/DR Strategy

Defines the strategic continuity and recovery approach.

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Business Continuity Plan

Defines how critical business activities continue during disruption.

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Disaster Recovery Plan

Defines how critical technology and infrastructure are technically recovered.

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Exercises & Testing

Validate the plans and recovery assumptions.

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Lessons Learned & Continual Improvement

Drive updates to the BIA, BCP, DRP, risk register, and controls.

5. Recovery Concepts

5.1 Maximum Tolerable Period of Disruption (MTPD)

The MTPD is the maximum period a business activity can remain unavailable before the resulting impact becomes unacceptable to the organization.

5.2 Recovery Time Objective (RTO)

The RTO is the target amount of time within which a business activity, system, or service should be restored following a disruption.

5.3 Recovery Point Objective (RPO)

The RPO is the target maximum amount of data loss, measured in time, that the organization can tolerate following a disruption.

5.4 Recovery Priority

Recovery priority determines the order in which business activities should be restored.

Priority	Definition
P1 — Critical	Highest recovery priority; activities with the shortest recovery requirements.
P2 — High	Important activities restored after P1 capabilities have stabilized.
P3 — Moderate	Supporting activities that may be restored after higher-priority activities.

6. Business Continuity Activation

The BCP may be activated when a disruption has the potential to:

- Prevent one or more critical business activities from operating normally.
- Cause a disruption approaching or exceeding defined recovery thresholds.
- Affect critical technology or cloud services.
- Cause loss of access to required personnel, facilities, or systems.
- Create significant supplier or third-party service disruption.
- Require coordinated response across multiple business functions.
- Create a situation where normal operational procedures are insufficient.

Activation should be proportional to the severity and expected duration of the disruption.

7. Incident and Continuity Levels

Level	Description	Example Response
Level 1 — Localized	Limited disruption affecting a small number of users or a non-critical capability.	Normal operational response.
Level 2 — Significant	Disruption affecting an important business capability or group.	Management escalation and continuity procedures as required.
Level 3 — Major	Significant disruption affecting one or more P1 activities or multiple business functions.	Formal BCP activation and coordinated recovery.
Level 4 — Critical	Severe disruption threatening sustained operation of critical business services.	Executive escalation, full continuity coordination, and prioritized recovery.

The incident level may be increased or decreased as information becomes available.

8. Decision and Escalation Thresholds

Decision and escalation thresholds provide objective criteria for determining when business continuity procedures should be activated, when an incident should be escalated, and when Executive Management involvement is required.

Thresholds should be assessed using the best information available at the time. When uncertainty exists, the organization should favor timely escalation rather than waiting for complete information.

8.1 General Escalation Principles

Escalation should consider:

- Actual or expected service disruption duration.
- Impact against MTPD and RTO requirements.
- Customer and business impact.
- Security implications.
- Data integrity or availability concerns.
- Number and criticality of affected services.
- Dependency or supplier impact.
- Availability of recovery personnel.
- Regulatory, contractual, or legal considerations.
- Whether normal operational procedures remain sufficient.

An incident may be escalated before a threshold is reached when the Incident Lead determines that the potential impact warrants earlier management involvement.

8.2 Business Continuity Activation Thresholds

Trigger	Threshold / Condition	Required Action
Localized disruption	Limited impact with no expected effect on critical recovery objectives	Continue normal operational response and monitor.
Significant disruption	Important business capability affected or disruption expected to continue beyond normal operating tolerance	Notify Incident Lead and assess BCP activation.
P1 service impact	Any confirmed or suspected disruption affecting a P1 activity	Initiate formal impact assessment and consider immediate BCP activation.
RTO risk	Forecasted recovery time is likely to exceed the defined RTO	Escalate to Incident Lead, Process Owner, and relevant technical/business leadership.
MTPD risk	Forecasted disruption may approach or exceed MTPD	Escalate to Executive Management and activate appropriate continuity measures.
Multiple business functions	Two or more significant business functions are materially affected	Establish coordinated continuity management.
Critical supplier disruption	Supplier outage threatens a P1 activity or may exceed its recovery objective	Escalate to supplier owner, Incident Lead, and relevant management.
Security concern	Disruption involves suspected compromise, unauthorized access, or material security-control failure	Coordinate with Security Lead and Incident Response procedures.
Communications failure	Primary communication capability is unavailable during a significant incident	Activate approved alternate communication channels.

8.3 RTO-Based Escalation

Recovery progress should be monitored against the defined RTO for each affected activity.

Recovery Status	Threshold	Escalation
Within target	Recovery is progressing within the approved RTO	Continue recovery and monitor.
At risk	Recovery is forecasted to exceed approximately 75% of the RTO without sufficient progress	Notify Incident Lead and Process Owner; reassess recovery strategy.
RTO breach imminent	Recovery reaches approximately 90% of the RTO without validated restoration	Escalate to relevant management and consider additional recovery resources or alternate procedures.
RTO exceeded	Recovery target has been exceeded	Formal management escalation; document cause, impact, decisions, and revised recovery estimate.
MTPD at risk	Continued disruption could approach the defined MTPD	Executive Management escalation and consideration of additional continuity options.

The 75% and 90% thresholds are early-warning indicators rather than replacements for the approved RTO or MTPD.

8.4 RPO and Data-Recovery Thresholds

Where data restoration is required, recovery teams should compare the available recovery point with the approved RPO.

Condition	Threshold / Example	Required Action
Within RPO	Recoverable data is within the approved RPO	Continue recovery and validate data integrity.
RPO at risk	Available recovery point is approaching the maximum permitted data-loss window	Escalate to Engineering/IT and assess alternate recovery points.
RPO breach	Available recovery point exceeds the approved RPO	Escalate to Incident Lead and relevant management; document expected data impact.
Backup unavailable	Required backup cannot be located or validated	Escalate immediately and assess alternate recovery sources.
Integrity concern	Restored data cannot be validated as complete or trustworthy	Pause affected restoration activity where appropriate and escalate to Security and Engineering/IT.

8.5 Decision Authority

Decision	Primary Authority	Escalation / Consultation
Continue normal operations	Process Owner / Incident Lead	Relevant functional owner
Activate continuity procedures	Incident Lead / Business Continuity-GRC Lead	Process Owner and relevant management
Escalate incident severity	Incident Lead	Security, Engineering/IT, Executive Management as appropriate
Prioritize P1 services	Incident Lead	Process Owners and Executive Management where significant trade-offs exist
Invoke manual workaround	Process Owner	Security / GRC where security or data risks are involved
Authorize emergency technical change	Authorized Engineering/IT leadership	Security and Incident Lead as required
Accept temporary operational risk	Appropriate Risk Owner	Executive Management when risk exceeds delegated authority
Declare recovery complete	Incident Lead with relevant technical/business owners	Executive Management for major incidents
Return to normal operations	Incident Lead / Process Owners	Engineering/IT, Security, GRC, Communications
Approve major continuity strategy change	Executive Management	ISMS Owner / GRC and affected business owners

Decision authority should be adapted to the organization's actual governance structure in an operational version of this plan.

8.6 Executive Management Escalation

Executive Management should be notified when one or more of the following conditions apply:

- A P1 service is materially disrupted.
- A P1 RTO is likely to be missed.
- An MTPD is at risk of being exceeded.
- Multiple critical business functions are affected.
- Material customer impact is expected.
- Significant data integrity or availability concerns exist.
- A major supplier or cloud dependency is unavailable.
- Significant security or compliance implications are identified.

- Recovery requires material business, financial, contractual, or resource decisions.
- Risk acceptance is required beyond delegated authority.
- The incident is expected to have prolonged or strategic business consequences.

Executive Management involvement does not replace operational incident leadership; it provides decision authority and organizational support for significant business-impact decisions.

8.7 Escalation Documentation

Significant escalation decisions should be recorded in an incident or decision log.

At minimum, the record should capture:

- Date and time.
- Decision or escalation trigger.
- Current incident severity.
- Affected business activity or service.
- RTO/RPO/MTPD status.
- Available evidence and assumptions.
- Decision made.
- Decision owner.
- Stakeholders consulted.
- Actions assigned.
- Target completion time.
- Follow-up or review requirement.

This provides an auditable record of how continuity decisions were made during the disruption.

8.8 Threshold Review

Decision and escalation thresholds should be reviewed during:

- Annual BCP review.
- BIA updates.
- Tabletop exercises.
- Significant incidents.
- Technical recovery tests.
- Material organizational or technology changes.

Thresholds should be adjusted when testing or operational experience demonstrates that they are unclear, impractical, or insufficiently responsive to business impact.

9. Business Continuity Roles

Role	Responsibility
Executive Management	Provides strategic direction, approves major decisions, and authorizes significant resource or business-impact decisions.
Business Continuity / GRC Lead	Coordinates BCP activation, maintains the plan, tracks continuity actions, and coordinates lessons learned.
Incident Lead	Coordinates the operational response and ensures appropriate escalation.
Engineering / IT Lead	Coordinates technology dependencies and works with the DR function on technical recovery.
Security Lead	Maintains security oversight, incident coordination, and security monitoring requirements.
Customer Operations Lead	Coordinates customer-support continuity and customer-impact communications.
Communications Lead	Coordinates approved internal and external communications.
Process Owners	Maintain continuity procedures for their assigned business activities.
All Personnel	Follow continuity procedures, report disruptions, and support recovery activities as assigned.

Specific individuals should be assigned to these roles within the operational version of the plan.

10. Activation Procedure

When a significant disruption is identified:

Step 1 — Identify

The disruption is identified and the initial impact is assessed.

Step 2 — Notify

The appropriate incident, business, security, and management personnel are notified.

Step 3 — Assess

The response team determines:

- Affected services.
- Affected business activities.
- Expected duration.
- Customer impact.
- Security implications.
- Supplier dependencies.
- Potential impact against MTPD and RTO.

Step 4 — Activate

If normal operational procedures are insufficient, the appropriate level of the BCP is activated.

Step 5 — Prioritize

P1 activities are prioritized based on the BIA and current business impact.

Step 6 — Communicate

Internal and external communications are initiated as appropriate.

Step 7 — Maintain

Continuity procedures and temporary workarounds remain in place while recovery activities proceed.

Step 8 — Transition

Once stable service has been restored, responsibility transitions back to normal operational teams.

11. Immediate Response Priorities

During a significant disruption, the organization should prioritize:

1. Personnel safety.
2. Incident identification and escalation.
3. Protection of information and evidence.
4. Establishment of incident leadership.
5. Identification of affected business activities.
6. Protection of critical systems and data.
7. Activation of appropriate continuity procedures.
8. Restoration of critical communications.
9. Coordination with technical recovery teams.

10. Customer and stakeholder communication where required.

12. Critical Business Activity Continuity

12.1 Customer Support & Service Operations

Objective

Maintain the ability to receive, prioritize, and respond to critical customer issues during a disruption.

Continuity Actions

- Prioritize critical customer-impacting issues.
- Use approved alternate communication channels if primary systems are unavailable.
- Maintain a temporary manual issue log when necessary.
- Coordinate closely with the Incident Lead.
- Communicate service-impact information through approved channels.
- Defer non-critical activities where necessary.

Recovery Priority

P1 — Critical

Modeled RTO

4 hours

Modeled RPO

24 hours

12.2 SaaS Platform Operations

Objective

Maintain or restore the organization's core SaaS platform and customer-facing services.

Continuity Actions

- Identify affected services and dependencies.
- Coordinate with Engineering and IT.
- Prioritize critical customer-facing functionality.
- Follow approved technical recovery procedures.
- Validate service functionality following restoration.
- Communicate material customer impact through approved channels.

Recovery Priority

P1 — Critical

Modeled RTO

2 hours

Modeled RPO

4 hours

Detailed technical recovery procedures are maintained in the Disaster Recovery Plan.

12.3 Identity & Access Administration

Objective

Maintain access for authorized personnel required to support business operations and recovery.

Continuity Actions

- Prioritize restoration of identity and access capabilities.
- Use approved emergency-access procedures where required.
- Maintain appropriate authorization and logging.
- Review emergency access after normal operations resume.
- Avoid bypassing security controls without documented authorization.

Recovery Priority

P1 — Critical

Modeled RTO

4 hours

Modeled RPO

24 hours

12.4 Security Monitoring & Incident Response

Objective

Maintain sufficient security visibility and incident-response capability during disruption.

Continuity Actions

- Continue monitoring available security telemetry.
- Escalate suspected security incidents through established procedures.
- Use alternate monitoring or manual escalation mechanisms where necessary.
- Protect incident evidence.
- Coordinate with technical recovery teams.
- Prioritize security risks associated with recovery activities.

Recovery Priority

P1 — Critical

Modeled RTO

2 hours

Modeled RPO

4 hours

12.5 Customer & Business Communications

Objective

Maintain reliable communication between personnel, customers, suppliers, and management.

Continuity Actions

- Activate approved alternate communication channels when necessary.

- Maintain communication contact lists.
- Coordinate messaging through the designated Communications Lead.
- Provide accurate and appropriately approved updates.
- Avoid sharing unverified or sensitive information.

Recovery Priority

P1 — Critical

Modeled RTO

4 hours

Modeled RPO

24 hours

12.6 Software Development & Release Management

Objective

Maintain the minimum development capability required to support critical recovery and security activities.

Continuity Actions

- Defer non-critical development and releases.
- Prioritize recovery and security-related changes.
- Maintain source-code availability.
- Follow change-management requirements.
- Coordinate emergency changes with appropriate technical and security personnel.

Recovery Priority

P2 — High

Modeled RTO

8 hours

Modeled RPO

24 hours

12.7 Vulnerability Management & Security Remediation

Objective

Maintain visibility and risk-based management of critical vulnerabilities during disruption.

Continuity Actions

- Prioritize critical and high-risk vulnerabilities.
- Use manual tracking where normal tooling is unavailable.
- Coordinate remediation with Engineering.
- Defer lower-risk activities where necessary.
- Resume normal vulnerability-management operations after stabilization.

Recovery Priority

P2 — High

Modeled RTO

8 hours

Modeled RPO

24 hours

12.8 Third-Party & Supplier Security Management

Objective

Maintain visibility of critical suppliers and address supplier disruptions affecting business operations.

Continuity Actions

- Identify affected suppliers.
- Contact critical suppliers through approved escalation channels.
- Prioritize suppliers supporting P1 services.
- Assess alternate providers or temporary workarounds where appropriate.
- Document supplier-related decisions and impacts.

Recovery Priority

P2 — High

Modeled RTO

24 hours

Modeled RPO

48 hours

12.9 ISMS Governance & Compliance

Objective

Maintain essential security governance and risk oversight during prolonged disruption.

Continuity Actions

- Maintain access to critical governance records.
- Continue high-priority risk tracking.
- Defer lower-priority governance activities where necessary.
- Maintain evidence required for critical compliance obligations.
- Resume normal governance activities following stabilization.

Recovery Priority

P3 — Moderate

Modeled RTO

72 hours

Modeled RPO

48 hours

12.10 Backup, Recovery & Data Restoration

Objective

Support restoration of critical information and technology services.

Continuity Actions

- Identify required recovery points.
- Validate available backups.
- Coordinate restoration with Engineering/IT.
- Validate restored information and systems.
- Document recovery results.
- Escalate failed or corrupted backups.

Recovery Priority

P1 — Critical

Modeled RTO

2 hours

Modeled RPO

4 hours

Detailed technical procedures are maintained in the Disaster Recovery Plan.

13. Manual Workarounds

Manual workarounds may be used when primary systems are unavailable and where doing so is practical and secure.

Capability	Temporary Workaround
Customer Support	Use approved alternate communication channels and manual issue tracking.
Identity & Access	Use authorized emergency-access procedures.
Security Monitoring	Use available logs, alternate monitoring, and manual escalation.
Development	Prioritize recovery/security changes and defer non-critical releases.
Vulnerability Management	Maintain manual tracking of critical vulnerabilities.

Supplier Management	Prioritize critical suppliers and use documented escalation contacts.
ISMS Governance	Use controlled offline copies of critical records where necessary.
Communications	Use approved alternate communication channels.

Manual procedures must maintain appropriate security, confidentiality, integrity, and authorization controls.

14. Communications Plan

Audience	Purpose	Primary Channel	Alternate Channel
Employees	Operational instructions and status updates	Approved collaboration/email	Alternate approved messaging/voice
Incident Team	Response coordination	Approved collaboration platform	Voice/manual escalation
Customers	Service-impact updates	Approved customer communication channel	Alternate approved channel
Suppliers	Recovery coordination	Supplier support/escalation channel	Secondary supplier contact
Executive Management	Decisions and escalation	Incident briefing	Voice/manual escalation
Regulators / Authorities	Required notifications	Formal approved channel	Approved alternate method

External notifications must be assessed against applicable legal, regulatory, contractual, and internal reporting requirements.

15. Supplier Continuity

Critical suppliers should be identified and maintained within the organization's supplier-risk process.

For critical suppliers, the organization should maintain:

- Current supplier contacts.
- Escalation contacts.
- Service descriptions.
- Dependency information.
- Relevant contractual commitments.

- Continuity and recovery information where available.
- Alternate service considerations where appropriate.

Supplier disruptions affecting P1 activities should be escalated to the appropriate Incident Lead and management personnel.

16. Personnel Continuity

Business continuity depends on maintaining sufficient personnel and knowledge to perform critical activities.

The organization should:

- Identify primary and backup personnel for critical activities.
- Maintain current contact information.
- Cross-train personnel where practical.
- Document critical responsibilities.
- Maintain appropriate access for authorized recovery personnel.
- Identify single-person dependencies.
- Ensure emergency responsibilities are understood.

Personnel safety remains the first priority during any disruptive event.

17. Information and Record Protection

During continuity operations, critical information should remain protected against:

- Unauthorized access.
- Accidental disclosure.
- Loss or destruction.
- Unauthorized modification.
- Improper use of emergency procedures.

Temporary records created during a disruption should be incorporated into normal systems and records once normal operations resume.

Sensitive information should not be moved to unauthorized systems merely to maintain convenience during an incident.

18. Return to Normal Operations

The transition back to normal operations should occur only after the appropriate recovery personnel determine that:

- Critical services are stable.
- Security controls are operating appropriately.
- Data integrity has been validated.
- Customer-facing services have been verified.
- Temporary workarounds are no longer required.
- Outstanding risks have been assessed.
- Relevant stakeholders have been informed.
- Temporary access or emergency procedures have been reviewed.

The Incident Lead should coordinate the transition with the relevant business and technical owners.

19. Post-Event Review

Following a significant disruption or BCP activation, the organization should conduct a post-event review.

The review should consider:

- What happened?
- Which business activities were affected?
- How long were services unavailable?
- Were RTOs achieved?
- Were RPOs achieved?
- Which continuity procedures worked?
- Which procedures failed or were unclear?
- Were communications effective?
- Were supplier dependencies managed effectively?
- Were sufficient personnel available?
- Were security requirements maintained?
- What corrective actions are required?

Lessons learned should be documented and assigned to appropriate owners.

20. Testing and Exercises

The BCP should be validated through periodic exercises and testing.

Testing activities may include:

Tabletop Exercises

Used to validate:

- Roles.
- Decision-making.
- Communications.
- Escalation.
- Recovery priorities.
- Business continuity procedures.

Technical Recovery Testing

Used to validate:

- System restoration.
- Backup recovery.
- Application recovery.
- Recovery sequencing.
- RTO/RPO assumptions.

Plan Reviews

Used to verify:

- Contact information.
- Responsibilities.
- Dependencies.
- Procedures.
- Recovery requirements.

Exercise results should be documented and tracked through corrective actions.

21. BCP Maintenance

The plan should be reviewed:

- At least annually.
- Following significant incidents.
- Following major exercises.
- Following material technology changes.
- Following major organizational changes.
- Following significant supplier changes.
- Following changes to legal, regulatory, or contractual requirements.
- When BIA recovery requirements materially change.

Changes should be version-controlled and approved through the appropriate governance process.

22. BCP Activation Checklist

The following checklist provides a high-level activation sequence.

Step	Action	Status
1	Identify and assess disruption	☐
2	Notify Incident Lead	☐
3	Determine affected business activities	☐
4	Determine severity/continuity level	☐
5	Notify required stakeholders	☐
6	Activate continuity procedures	☐
7	Prioritize P1 activities	☐
8	Activate manual workarounds where required	☐
9	Coordinate technical recovery	☐
10	Provide stakeholder communications	☐
11	Validate service restoration	☐
12	Transition to normal operations	☐
13	Conduct post-event review	☐
14	Track corrective actions	☐

23. Related Documents

This plan should be used alongside:

- Business Impact Analysis (BIA)
 - BCP/DR Strategy
 - Disaster Recovery Plan
 - Incident Response Policy
 - Information Security Policy
 - Access Control Policy
 - Asset Management Policy
 - Third-Party Security Policy
 - Risk Register
 - Statement of Applicability
 - Tabletop Exercise Materials
 - Testing and Lessons Learned Records
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24. Document Review

This plan should be reviewed periodically to ensure that it remains aligned with:

- Business requirements.
- Risk assessments.
- Technology architecture.
- Organizational responsibilities.
- Supplier dependencies.
- Recovery objectives.
- Security requirements.
- Applicable legal and contractual obligations.

Any identified gaps should be documented and tracked through the organization's corrective-action and continual-improvement process.

25. Portfolio Disclaimer

This Business Continuity Plan is a fictional cybersecurity/GRC portfolio artifact created to demonstrate practical application of business continuity and disaster recovery principles.

The recovery objectives, roles, procedures, dependencies, and assumptions are modeled examples. A real organization's BCP would require validation, approval, testing, and ongoing maintenance by appropriate business, technical, security, and executive stakeholders.